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TikTok lures songwriters with new promotional features

TikTok is adding new features to its app to let songwriters highlight their works. These features, rolling out in beta, include a “Songwriter” label and a new tab where they can show off their music.

The company said a limited number of publishing partners and songwriters have access to the new label and the music highlight section. Those who want to be part of the program will have to join [a waitlist](#).

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TikTok said that it surveyed over 870 songwriters and interviewed several to understand their needs in relation to profile building and creating monetization opportunities. The company also pointed to an [independent survey](#), which indicated that more than half of songwriters who use social media to promote their profile use TikTok to do it. The ByteDance-owned app said that the outcome of these surveys drove the decision to build these features.

IMAGE CREDITS:

ARTUR WIDAK/NURPHOTO / GETTY IMAGES

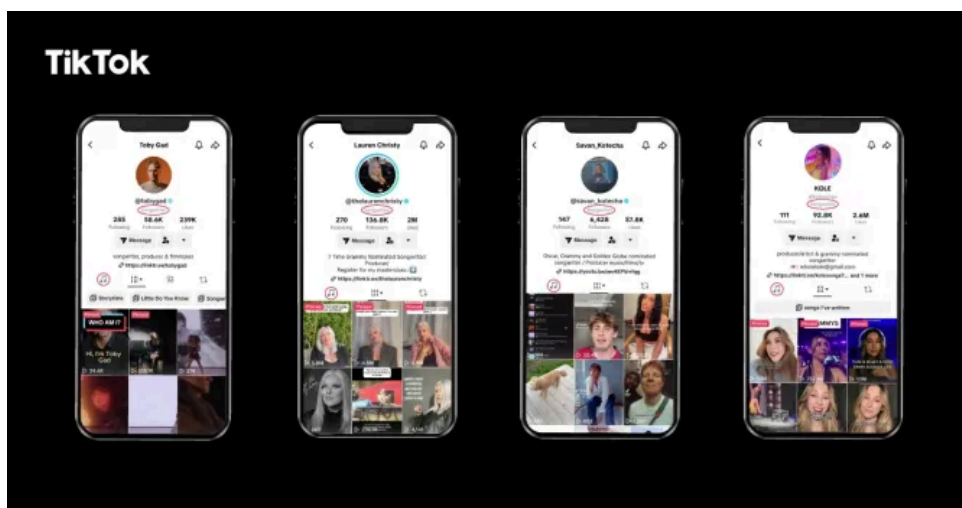


IMAGE CREDITS:TIKTOK

“TikTok is unique in its ability to offer songwriters a way to highlight their musical works alongside their own content, helping them to tell stories about their music, their craft, and their lives, and to raise their profile and build their audience

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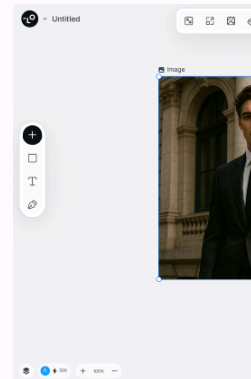
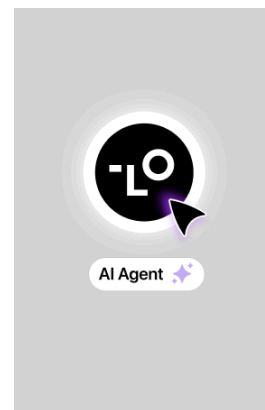
on TikTok, as hundreds of thousands of artist creators already do,” TikTok’s Global Head of Music Publishing Licensing and Partnership Jordan Lowy said in a statement.

TikTok joins streaming services like Spotify, which has let [songwriters highlight their work for years](#) now. Last year, Tidal [launched a tool](#) to let musicians track royalties and manage their work for which they have songwriting credits.

While TikTok decided to [shut down its music streaming service, TikTok Music](#), last year, the platform still remains important for users to discover new music and for artists to promote their tracks. Earlier this year, the company [released a TikTok for Artists tool](#) that lets artists monitor the performance of their campaign and tracks.

Topics: [Apps](#) [music streaming](#) [songwriters](#) [TikTok](#)

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Ivan Mehta

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously worked at publications includin...

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TikTok launches its music streaming service in

Australia, Mexico and Singapore

Aisha Malik — 3:00 PM PDT · July 18, 2023



TikTok

TikTok is launching its new subscription-only music streaming service called “TikTok Music” in Australia, Mexico and Singapore. Today’s expansion comes almost two weeks after TikTok [debuted the music streaming service](#) in Brazil and Indonesia.

The streaming service lets users sync the service to their existing TikTok accounts and listen, download and share songs. The service includes the catalogs of major record companies, including Universal Music Group, Warner Music Group and Sony Music.

IMAGE CREDITS: YUI MOK/PA IMAGES / GETTY IMAGES

TikTok says it’s inviting users in Australia, Mexico and Singapore to participate in the TikTok Music closed beta test starting today. To join, users need to download the TikTok Music app from the Apple App Store or Google Play Store or by visiting music.tiktok.com. All participants in the closed beta will receive a three-month free trial of the service.

The company told TechCrunch that a TikTok Music subscription costs AUD11.99 (\$8.16 USD) per month in Australia, Mex\$115 (\$6.86 USD) in Mexico and S\$9.90 (\$7.48 USD) in Singapore.

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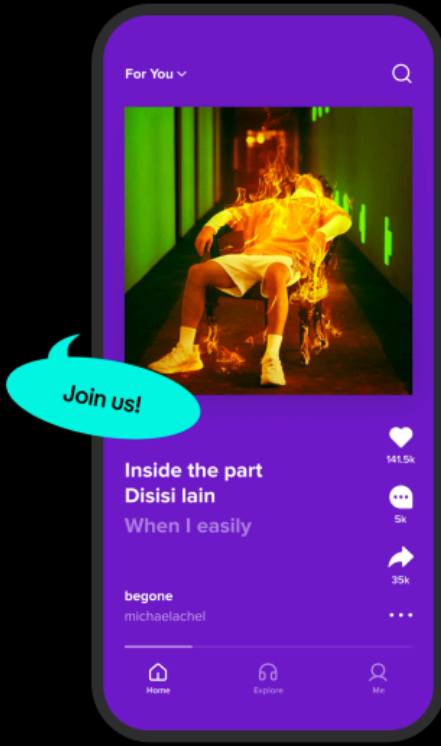


IMAGE CREDITS: TIKTOK

TikTok hasn't shared any details about when it plans to launch the streaming service in the United States, but says it will have more to share about the streaming service soon. It's been over a year since TikTok parent company ByteDance [filed a trademark application](#) with the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office for a service called "TikTok Music."

"TikTok Music is a new kind of music service that combines the power of music discovery on TikTok with a music streaming service offering millions of tracks from thousands of artists," a spokesperson for the company said in an email. "We are now beta testing TikTok Music in Australia, Mexico and Singapore, and will have more news to share on the launch of TikTok Music in the coming months."

TikTok is already a popular tool for discovering music, and oftentimes can lead to songs rising in popularity after they're used in viral videos and trends. By offering users a way to listen to and discover music, the company is directly competing with the likes of Spotify, Apple and Amazon.



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The streaming service lets you listen to full versions of viral TikTok songs, discover personalized music recommendations, access lyrics in real time, create collaborative playlists with friends, import your music library and find songs via a lyrics search feature. TikTok Music features a Shazam-like functionality and also lets you download songs for offline listening. Plus, the service includes social features, as TikTok notes that users can express themselves through comments and connect with other music lovers.

[TikTok launches a music streaming service in Brazil and Indonesia called 'TikTok Music'](#)

Topics: [Apps](#) [music streaming](#) [Social](#) [TikTok](#) [Tiktok Music](#)



Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter |

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporter at MobileSyrup. Aisha...

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TikTok launches a music streaming service in Brazil and Indonesia called ‘TikTok Music’

Aisha Malik — 10:26 AM PDT · July 6, 2023

IMAGE CREDITS:

PATRICK T. FALLON/AFP / GETTY IMAGES

TikTok has already dominated the short-video and social media market, and is now looking to take on Spotify and Apple Music with its latest offering.

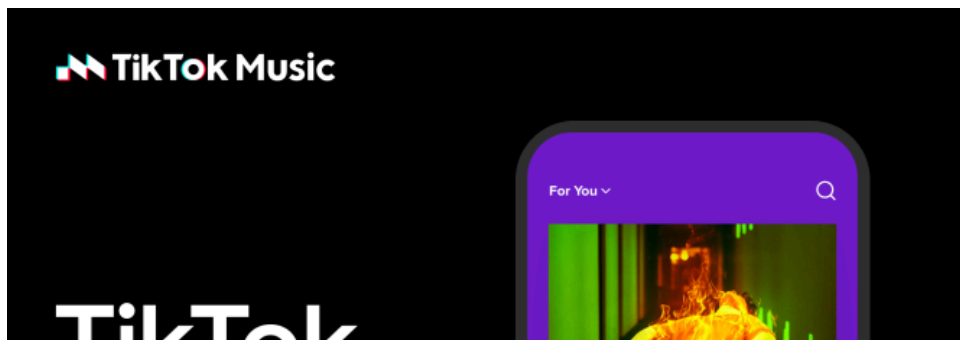
The company announced today that it’s launching a new subscription-only music streaming service called “TikTok Music” in Brazil and Indonesia. TikTok Music lets users sync the service to their existing TikTok accounts and listen, download and share songs. The service includes the catalogs of major record companies, including Universal Music Group, Warner Music Group and Sony Music.

TikTok Music lets you play full versions of viral TikTok songs, discover personalized music recommendations, access lyrics in real time, create collaborative playlists with friends, import your music library and find songs via lyrics search. The service also includes a Shazam-like feature that can identify music that you’re listening to. Like Spotify Premium, TikTok Music lets users download songs for offline listening. The

service also includes social features, as TikTok notes that users can express themselves through comments and connect with other music lovers.

When asked if TikTok plans to launch the streaming service in the United States, a spokesperson for the company said TikTok doesn't have anything to share at the moment. "We are excited about the opportunities for TikTok Music, for music fans, artists and the industry, but we don't have any more news to share on future plans," the spokesperson said in an email.

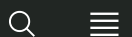
The service will replace ByteDance's existing streaming service, Resso, which will shut down on September 5 in Brazil and Indonesia. Resso also operates in India, but TikTok hasn't said when or if TikTok Music will launch in the country.



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A TikTok Music subscription costs \$3.49 a month in Brazil, and \$3.25 for iOS users in Indonesia. Android users in Indonesia will pay \$2.96 a month for the first year, then \$3.25 afterwards. TikTok Music doesn't include a free membership option, but offers a one-month free trial.

"We are pleased to introduce TikTok Music, a new kind of service that combines the power of music discovery on TikTok

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Instagram takes on Snapchat with new 'Instagram Map'

Aisha Malik - 18 hours ago

with a best-in-class streaming service. TikTok Music will make it easy for people in Indonesia and Brazil to save, download and share their favourite viral tracks from TikTok,” said Ole Obermann, global head of Music Business Development at TikTok, in a statement. “We are excited about the opportunities TikTok Music presents for both music fans and artists, and the great potential it has for driving significant value to the music industry.”

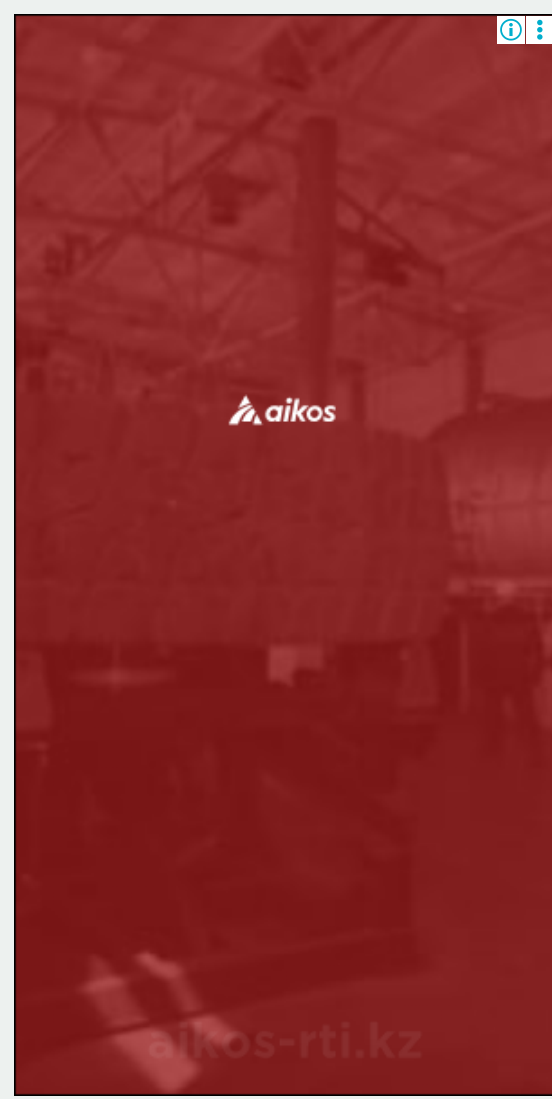
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Today’s announcement doesn’t come as a surprise, especially since TikTok parent company ByteDance [filed a trademark application](#) with the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office in May 2022 for a service called “TikTok Music.”

TikTok is already a popular tool for discovering music, and oftentimes can lead to songs rising in popularity after they’re used in viral videos and trends. By offering users a way to listen to and discover music, the company is directly competing with the likes of Spotify, Apple and Amazon. However, it’s worth noting that Spotify and Amazon Music offer ad-supported, free memberships.

In order to compete with popular music streaming services, TikTok will have to offer an interface that’s worth switching over for, while also providing value for users. For instance, TikTok Music is only slightly cheaper than Spotify Premium in Brazil and Indonesia, so it may be difficult for the company to convince users to choose its service over a competitor’s.

Although today’s announcement doesn’t include anything about podcast and radio content, ByteDance’s trademark application from last year suggested that the service could be used to “provide users with podcast and radio broadcast content.” The addition of podcast content alongside music would make TikTok Music an even bigger competitor to Apple Music and Spotify.

[After dominating the short-video market, TikTok may be considering a music service](#)

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Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#)

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporter at MobileSyrup. Aisha...

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ByteDance is shutting down TikTok Music globally



ByteDance said it is shuttering its music streaming service, TikTok Music, in November.

"We are sorry to inform you that TikTok Music will be closing on 28 November 2024," a [notice](#) on TikTok Music's website reads. The service was available in Indonesia, Brazil, Australia, Singapore and Mexico.

Subscribers can continue to use the service until November 28, after which renewals will be automatically canceled, the notice said. Users who want to transfer their playlists to other streaming services would need to do so by October 28, and refund requests would need to be submitted by November 28.

IMAGE CREDITS: BYTEDANCE

"Our Add to Music App feature has already enabled hundreds of millions of track saves to playlists on partner music streaming services. We will be closing TikTok Music at the end of November in order to focus on our goal of furthering TikTok's role in driving even greater music listening and value on music streaming services, for the benefit of artists, songwriters, and the industry," Ole Obermann, Global Head of Music Business Development, TikTok said in a statement.

TikTok said that it will continue partnering with music streaming services rather than competing with them. In February, the company launched "Add to Music" feature on TikTok that lets users add tracks directly to a playlist on Apple Music, Amazon Music, or Spotify.

TikTok Music was rooted in a [ByteDance product called Resso](#), which was first launched in India and Indonesia in 2019 and later expanded to Brazil.

In 2023, ByteDance rebranded [Resso to TikTok Music in Brazil and Indonesia](#), and soon after expanded it to [Singapore](#),

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[Australia and Mexico](#). Resso was banned [early this year in India](#).

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TikTok has become a popular way for people to discover music, and serves as a [launchpad](#) for artists, driving their streams. TikTok has a significant impact on increasing [value for artists via streaming and fueling music discovery](#), per a study conducted by TikTok and entertainment data research firm Lumiate.

Bytedance, which also owns a music distribution [platform called SoundOn](#), likely wanted to bank on TikTok's popularity to drive streams within its own ecosystem, but the service didn't expand internationally beyond a few markets.

TikTok also has had a shaky relationship with the music industry lately. Earlier this year, Universal Music Group pulled its [music catalog out of the service after disagreements over royalties](#). In response, TikTok called out UMG for "false narrative nad rhetoric." In March, both parties called a truce and [signed a new deal](#).

Separately, TikTok is fighting a case against a bill that [would possibly lead to the short video app](#) being banned in the U.S. This might have hampered ByteDance's plans of expanding TikTok Music to markets like the U.S.

The story has been updated with ByteDance's response.

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